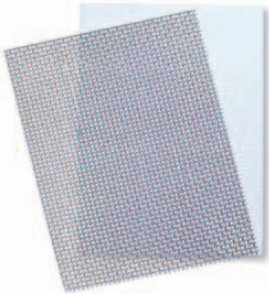


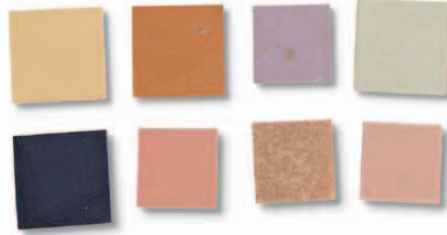


**Hand carders** Use carders to blend fibres and straighten out unruly tufts of fleece. They come as a pair. The edge nearest the handle is called the “heel” and the opposite edge is the “toe”.



**Firing brick and mesh** To protect your work surface, place metal clay pieces on a sheet of stainless steel mesh over a heatproof fibre brick while heating them with a torch.

**Scents** Essential oils are ideal for creating aromatherapy soaps, while synthetic fragrances offer a range of additional scent options. Only use essential oils or fragrances that are safe for cosmetic use.



**Unglazed ceramic mosaic tiles** Unglazed ceramic is a hard-wearing material that can be used on walls and floors. Tiles come in two sizes, 2 x 2cm ( $\frac{3}{4}$  x  $\frac{3}{4}$ in) and 24 x 24mm (1 x 1in), and in an attractive range of muted colours.



**Colourants** Cosmetic pigments, dyes, and micas (powdered minerals) offer a safe and lasting way to colour soap. Food colours can also be used but are prone to fading so are best avoided.



**Fabric paint pens** Use these to outline edges and define shapes once the main design is complete.



gel wax



soy wax



beeswax

**Wax** There are different types of wax: beeswax, soy wax, gel wax, and petroleum (paraffin) wax. Beeswax and soy wax are natural, clean-burning products. Soy wax is available in flakes and, as it is water-soluble, it is easy to remove from pans and utensils after use.



**Tile nippers** This is the essential tool for mosaic cutting and can be used on all mosaic materials. The blades must be tungsten-tipped. It's worth paying a bit more to get a pair that will cut accurately.



**Dyes** These are available in flake and liquid forms. Flakes are easy to cut, measure, and handle, and produce no mess.